

Count Down Under

Sprint log | GAME 1501 A3, Pitch-Ready Prototype
Sprint cycle 28 July to 21 August 2026 | Group of four

Method and sprint boundaries

The cycle ran as one-week sprints, Tuesday to Monday. The prototype was carried forward from a four-day game jam build of the same game and rebuilt as a new project on day one. A fourth sprint ran short, cut off by the submission deadline on the Friday.

Sprint	Window	Contributors active
Sprint 1	Tue 28 July to Mon 3 August	4
Sprint 2	Tue 4 August to Mon 10 August	4
Sprint 3	Tue 11 August to Mon 17 August	3
Sprint 4	Tue 18 August to Fri 21 August (short)	1 building, 3 testing

This log was assembled from the project's commit history and the playtest notes. Sprint scope is stated as what the sprint's commits show the group working toward, because scope was agreed verbally and in chat rather than written down at the time. Where a decision cannot be evidenced it is marked rather than asserted.

Sprint 1: stand the project up

Window: Tuesday 28 July to Monday 3 August

Scope

Rebuild the jam prototype as a clean project, get a controllable player moving in a scene, and put a UI shell in place around it.

Built

- Project skeleton: repository, default package set, CoreUtils, the `_Project` folder structure, fonts, and the scenes carried across from the jam build.
- 2D player controller written fresh rather than ported, plus flight time tuning and the blood-drain interaction.
- First animation set: two-frame runs, idle and running animations.
- UI shell: a dedicated UI testing scene, button prefabs, main menu, settings menu, game screen and two end screens, applied across every scene.
- Art migrated from the jam project: sprites, textures, icon and screen art, TextMeshPro.

Playtest

None. The build was not yet in a state a player could be given.

Revision decisions

- Rebuild the player controller rather than carry the jam version forward. Recorded in the branch name `RebuildingPlayerController`.
- Migrate the jam's art wholesale rather than reauthor it, so sprint time went to systems.
- Recreate the UI in a separate test scene first, then apply it to each scene, rather than building it in place.

Coordination

Branch per feature, merged into a shared staging branch by one person. Branches this sprint: 48-walking, Art-Migration, RebuildingPlayerController, EnviromentSprites, Effects-Enviroment, Finishing-Player, 15-bat.

Sprint 2: content and the core loop

Window: Tuesday 4 August to Monday 10 August

Scope

Fill the prototype out: a full animation set, hazards and obstacles, a designed level, and the loop that makes a run start, run down and end.

Built

- Character art pipeline: Maya scenes for the bat, NPCs and vampire rendered to frames, chroma key removed, resized to 512, and assembled into sheets. Kangaroo walk cycle. Extra vampire frames. Eating start and finish loops. NPC idle and death.
- Hazards, traversable objects and their prefabs; obstacle infrastructure and movement strategies; particle system rework.
- Level design delivered as a five-phase sequence by one contributor, with backdrop elements.
- Core loop: time wired up, blood drain, clock, blood splatter, run ending.
- Presentation: menus hooked up, pause, controls and settings screens working, vignette, invincibility-frame blinking and health bar flashing, music and damage audio.
- The “Sights to See” objective counter.

Playtest

Monday 10 August, at the sprint boundary. Two sessions in one afternoon: an expert review by a former instructor, and an observed session with a first-time player. Full records are in the accompanying playtest record set.

Revision decisions

- Adopt the 10 August observations as the whole of sprint 3, in place of the remaining planned feature work.
- Treat the two observations that concerned already-shipped work, the objective counter and the vampire frame count, as unfinished rather than closed.
- Decline “the people should flee from Dracula” on scope grounds and record it as a candidate for further development.

Coordination

Same branch-per-feature model, with level design handed to a single owner as a numbered sequence so it could land without conflicting with animation work. Branches this sprint: feature/Obstacles, feature/AnimsAndDamage, feature/NpcIdleandDeath, HazardsAndPrefabbing, EffectSystemsAndUI, LevelDesign, 15-bat, _FinalBatExport.

Sprint 3: act on the feedback

Window: Tuesday 11 August to Monday 17 August

Scope

No new features. Every item in this sprint answers an observation from 10 August.

Built

- Animation: falling and eating animations for the player, NPC idle and death replaced in the game scene, a further bat pass.
- Crocodile and kangaroo art produced and animated, answering the confusion over which animal carried the lunge attack.
- Cinemachine camera with lookahead, answering the reported delay on directional change.
- Lighting prefabs and a post-processing pass, then a second pass, answering the rendering notes.
- Level design update to the game scene and a dawn fade, answering the tunnel readability notes.
- Particle effects re-enabled, smoke trail corrected to trail behind, audio trigger frequency increased, button sizes and background images corrected, UI prefab updates.

Playtest

None. The sprint was spent implementing the previous sprint's findings and no further session was scheduled.

Revision decisions

- Ship the sightseeing objective incomplete rather than redesign it inside the final sprint.
- Leave the reported difficulty concern unaddressed; it was not picked up by any contributor.
- Prioritise readability and feel work over new content for the remainder of the cycle.

Coordination

Fewer branches and more direct commits than the previous sprints, with three contributors active rather than four. Branches this sprint: UIUpdates, EnvironmentImports.

Sprint 4: the widest feedback round, and four days to use it

Window: Tuesday 18 August to Friday 21 August, cut short by the submission deadline

Scope

Get the build in front of as many players as possible and spend the remaining days on whatever the feedback made unavoidable.

Built

- Web build resolution set to 1280x720; end screen prefab reference repaired and its scaling reset.
- Sunrise timer set to 180 seconds, then cut to 90 after the first round of feedback.
- Placeholder objective list turned off; unused text removed from the second end screen.
- Player hitbox tightened.
- Attack and idle strategies modified in an attempt to separate the crocodile and the kangaroo.
- Standalone Windows build produced.
- Custom 16:9 WebGL template. Menu art had been misaligning in the windowed web build because every UI prefab's Canvas Scaler matches on width, so any non-16:9 window produced a logical canvas height the background art was not authored for.

Playtest

The widest round of the project. Two players outside the programme were observed directly on 18 August, and between 18 and 21 August three team members recruited further players and relayed their findings in the project Discord. Full records are in the accompanying playtest record set.

Revision decisions

- Halve the sunrise timer rather than redesign the objective, on the grounds that a shorter run restores pressure immediately and a redesign does not fit in four days.

- Retire the placeholder objective list rather than finish the sightseeing objective behind it.
- Revert moving the jump attack onto the kangaroo. It left players stuck against obstacles with no escape, even with a longer cooldown, so the asymmetry between the two animals ships unresolved.
- Ship with the blue letterbox on non-16:9 displays and the placeholder squares on the sightseeing and airport triggers, both recorded as known and open.

Coordination

The division of labour inverted. From 18 August every commit on the project came from one person, while the other three found players and sent back notes. It moved quickly and it left implementation with a single point of failure for the last four days of the cycle.

Known and shipped open

Recorded rather than fixed, because sprint 4 had four days in it.

- Untextured placeholder squares on the sightseeing spots and the airport ending trigger. The interactions work; the markers should not be visible.
- Player bite alignment against the victim models.
- The letterbox on non-16:9 displays renders blue rather than black.
- Crocodile and kangaroo balance, after the reverted attempt to move the jump attack.
- Browsers reserve Escape to exit fullscreen, so Escape both pauses and drops fullscreen in the web build. Pause is also bound to P and to gamepad Start, which is the clean alternative.

Coordination across the cycle

The group used a branch-per-feature model for the first three sprints, with a shared staging branch and one person integrating and producing builds. Fifteen named feature branches were merged and no work was lost to a merge. In sprint 4 the shape inverted: one person committed and the other three recruited and observed players.

Three gaps are worth recording. Playtest notes were kept on paper or in chat and never filed in the repository, so no commit references the session that caused it. Builds were produced by one person for the whole cycle. And player observation was concentrated into the final four days, having happened once in the preceding three weeks. All three are addressed in the individual reflection.

Accompanying documents: playtest record set, individual reflection, runnable build.